

PO Header / Item Notes Reuse - Modernization

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1. Current Situation

1.1 Legacy SAPScript Text Persistence

Purchase Order Notes (long texts) are stored using the classic SAPScript persistence mechanism, which is shared across many SAP Business Objects. The underlying infrastructure consists of:

Table	Purpose
STXH	Text header (text object, text ID, language, key)
STXL	Text content lines (cluster table)
STXB	Text binary data (cluster table)

Texts are read and written via SAP function modules `READ_TEXT` and `SAVE_TEXT`. The storage format is the `ITF` (Internal Text Format), which is an SAP-proprietary format that can only be processed by SAP-internal functions and is not accessible to external tools, analytical platforms, or AI frameworks.

1.2 Current PO Notes Access Architecture

The current RAP-based access to PO Notes follows this CDS dependency chain:

```
R_PurchaseOrderNoteTP
├─ R_PurchaseOrderPlainLongText
│   └─ I_TextObjectPlainLongText
│       └─ esh_sr_ltxt ← Replicated SAPScript longtext table (Enterprise Search)
```

1.3 ESH_SR_LTXT – The Root Cause of the Problem

The table `esh_sr_ltxt` is a replicated SAPScript long text table provided exclusively in the context of Enterprise Search (ESH). It was never intended to serve as a data source for transactional or display use cases in RAP APIs.

Reference: [Long text SAPScript search enablement for CDS-based search – Wiki@SAP](#) .

2. Problems with the current architecture

2.1 Incorrect Use of Enterprise Search Replication Infrastructure:

The `ESH_SR_LTXT` replication pipeline was designed solely to make SAPScript texts searchable via Enterprise Search. Using it to display or provide transactional `PO` Notes data violates the intended scope of this infrastructure and creates an undocumented dependency on a feature that may change or be removed independently.

2.2 No Text Formatting Support:

Because the notes content is sourced from the ESH replication layer (which produces plain text for indexing purposes), rich text formatting from the original SAPScript `ITF` representation is lost. Customers have already reported this as a functional gap.

2.3 Unsuitability for Modern Use Cases:

The cluster tables are not supported for Analytics & Extraction, `AI/LLM` Integration, `BDC`, `oDATA API` Exposure with formatted text.

2.4 Prerequisite for Notes `RAP` Reuse Component

The `PO` Modernization `API` has the requirement to plug in the Notes `RAP` Reuse component. For this, moving to a new persistency is a prerequisite.

3. Target Architecture (New Persistency Concept)

The Open questions have to be clarified with the below list of teams

SAPScript Text team:

Sales New persistency team: Chris, Xi; Karen Feng

Notes Reuse `RAP BO` team:

Procurement Notes Reuse team: BLR04 team (M K, Visakh)

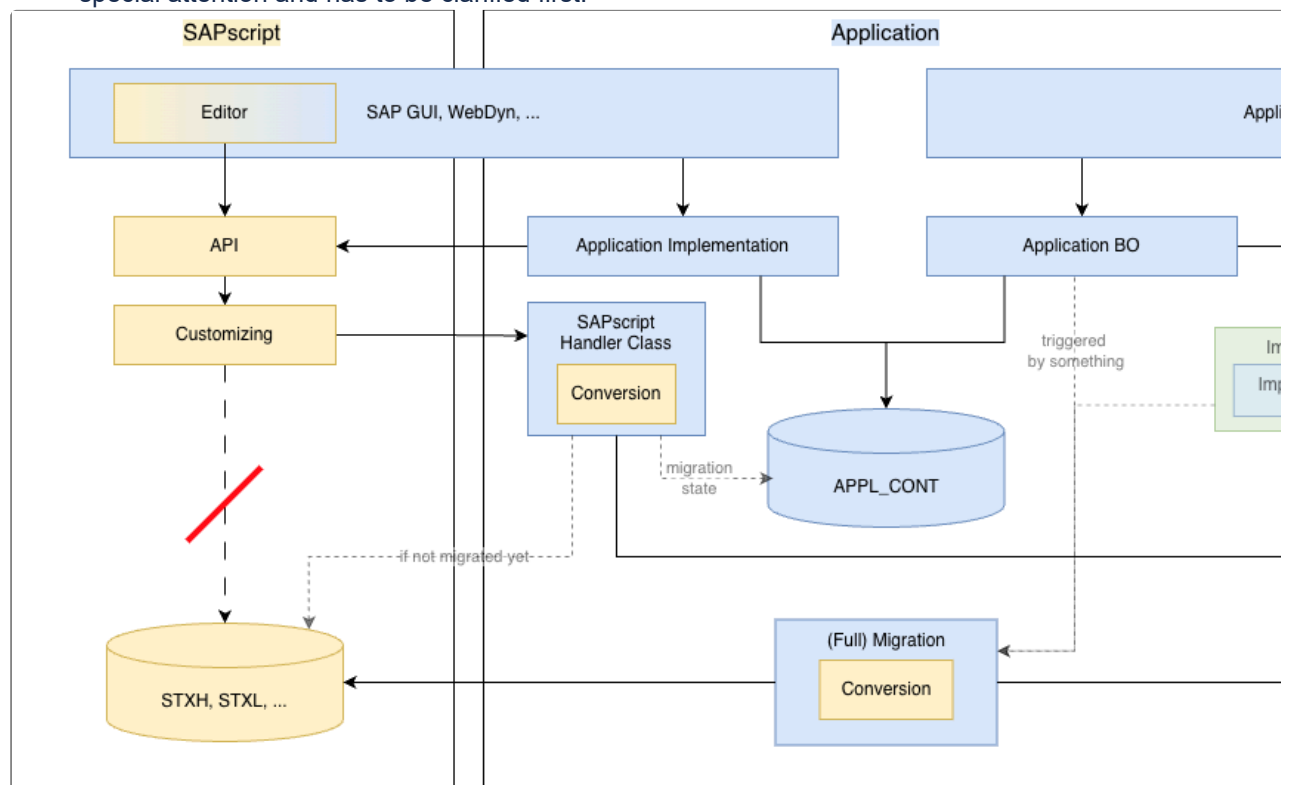
Purchase Order team : Lift & Shift team & WDF11 team

Motivation: For the Modernized `PO API`, we would like to use `RAP` Notes Reuse Object. As a prerequisite to this, it is recommended to move the Notes into new persistency. We are not yet clear whether we need to move to our own persistency, Or can we use the generic persistency `SGBT_NTE_CONT`. - Verify this with **`RAP` Notes Reuse team**.

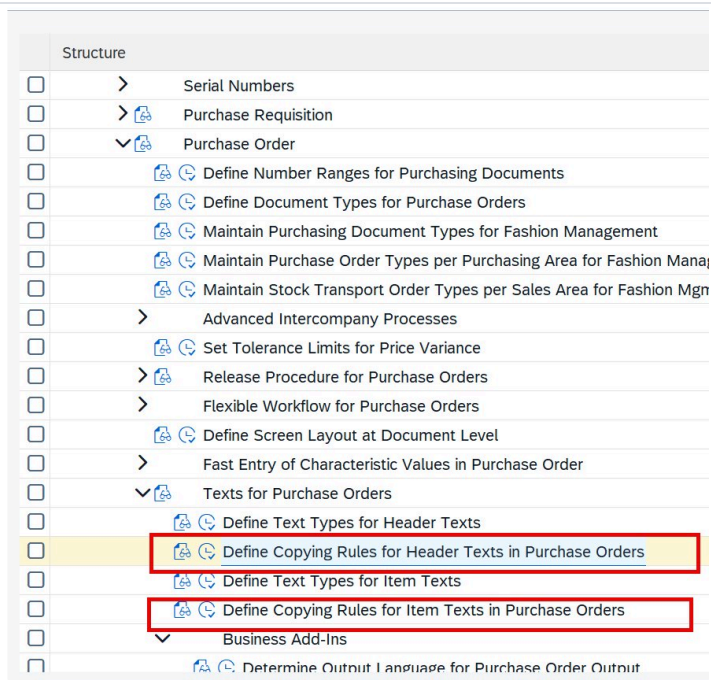
Open Questions:

- **The SAPScript text team** has published the official guidelines for migrating to the application specific persistency. The guidelines are available in [Application-specific persistence of SAPscript texts - Forms Services - Wiki@SAP](#)
 - We have to make sure that the data is written to both persistency until Silent Data Migration is completed.
 - The existing scenarios should not be affected (whoever use the old persistency) - Regression tests are needed from other `BO`.
 - Check `SDM` Delivery (Before/after) - Is it possible to have `SDM` delivery and new persistency delivery in the same release?
- **The Sales team** also moved to the new persistency by following the above guidelines and we need to have a detailed analysis on the architectural decisions that they have taken.
 - Sales team came up with a new persistency table based on the wiki [Application-specific persistence of SAPscript texts - Forms Services - Wiki@SAP](#). The Design document is attached [SDD New Persistency for Long Texts V10.docx](#). Purchase Order can check whether we can follow similar approach

- As per the [Note Reuse RAP BO WIKI \(CONCEPT\) Application-specific long text persistence - Generic Business Services - Wiki@SAP](#), it make use of the generic persistency table `sgbt_nte_cont`. Sales have not followed the similar approach. Instead of that they have come up with a separate table for all Sales related BOs. - The below points have to be clarified with the SAPScript texts migration team, RAP Notes Reuse Component and the Sales longtext team.
 - For example, in Supplier confirmation BO, we make use of the generic table `SGBT_NTE_CONT`. This is working fine until now.
 - Sales didn't go for similar concept because `SGBT_NTE_CONT` is a generic table and they would like to include SD specific attributes
 - BC-SRV-GBT-NTE owns the table `SGBT_NTE_CONT`, any changes in the future are risks for application.
 - The guideline mentioned in the wiki [Application-specific persistence of SAPscript texts - Forms Services - Wiki@SAP](#) says that if we follow the approach mentioned there, they do not have to existing application codes and the integration is smooth. They have not mentioned anything specifically for `SGBT_NTE_CONT` table.
 - The architectural diagram mentioned in the wiki [\(CONCEPT\) Application-specific long text persistence - Generic Business Services - Wiki@SAP](#) says that RAP Notes Reuse BO works with `SGBT_NTE_CONT`. In this case, we would like to know how a separate persistency as mentioned in [Application-specific persistence of SAPscript texts - Forms Services - Wiki@SAP](#) will work. - This needs special attention and has to be clarified first.



- Purchase Order Notes** scope in Public Cloud: There are few pre analysis that has to be done from Purchase Order side to finalize the scope
 - Purchase Order Notes: Which all BOs are using the Purchase Order text object `EKKO` and `EKPO`?
 - Are they sharing the same text IDs or different ones?
 - Can the customers in public cloud create own text IDs and use them?
 - The current Notes table uses the same text object `EKKO`, `EKPO` for multiple Business Objects. It is not only for Purchase Order BO.
 - We need to come up with a phased approach as the other business objects are not yet aware about this change
 - We can check the possibilities to only move Purchase Order BO into new persistency. (The persistence handler class can be registered in SE75 at text object level and at text ID level as well.). We need to also check whether the same text ID is shared by other BOs.
 - Sales team had similar situation and we need to check how this is achieved.
 - How the referencing in purchase Order Notes work?
 - The new persistence APIs do not support references out of the box. Check wiki [Text references - Forms Services - Wiki@SAP](#). Check with Sales team how this is handled in their Business Objects



Display Text Linkages: Header Texts Purchase Order

▼

More ▼

Dialog Structure

▼

Text types

Text linkages

Target text:

Header Text

	Source Object	Source text	Fix
☐	Supplier Master	Purchase Order Text	
☐	RFQ/Quotation	Header Text	
☐	Purchase Order	Header Text	
☐	Contract	Release Order Text	

4. Delivery Timelines (Phased Approach)

CE2702 (Analysis + Concept + POC)	
1	Clarify the Open points with • <u>RAP</u> Notes Reuse <u>BO</u> team • SAPScript text - application specific persistency team • Sales team - Notes New persistency
2	Analyze the Open points from Purchase Order <u>BO</u>

CE2708 (Implementation + Regression Tests)	
1	Productive Implementation of the new persistency
2	Create required views, BDEFs for the new persistency
3	Plugin PO Notes BO into RAP Reuse interface of the Modernized API

CE2802 (Status check for all BOs + SDM planning)	
1	Check the status of all linked BOs
2	SDM Planning + Execution (If all BOs are completed)
3	Regression tests for all linked BOs + Purchase Order legacy apps (ME21N, Manage PO, APIs)

	individual BOs + Sign-off Also include Procurement Notes Reuse team and all affected BOs in loop.		(ME21N, Manage PO, APIs)	
4	POC in DDCI system: • New persistency / generic persistency table • Required views, BDEFs etc if needed • Writing into old and new persistency have to be enabled. • MEPORules have to be adjusted (Need to plan) in DDCI system - The same will be copied to ER1 once POC is done	5	Linked BOs of EKKO EKPO text object - Start with the analysis + POC (based on the concept document) Include Procurement Notes Reuse team	
		6	Check SDM Delivery	

CE2702 : RAP Reuse Notes in PO is not a part of the MVS in Modernization.

Analyze the open points in purchase order BO. Clarify our requirement and open points with RAP Reuse Notes BO team, SAPScript new persistency migration and Sales team.

Once this is done, come up with an Architectural Concept / Design document for the Purchase Order Notes persistency topic. Invite other BO teams for the rollout and keep them posted about the time lines. The SDM can be done only once all BOs are moved to the new persistency. Until then Notes will be written to both old and new persistency tables.

The BLR04 team (Procurement Notes Reuse team), Vikas, Chinmay, Nils, Jiss and Vikas etc have to be kept in loop.

Once the concept document is presented to the teams and sign-off is done, a POC in DDCI system is recommended in CE2702 release. The POC scope will be to move the Purchase Order Notes to the new persistency without interrupting the existing logic.

POC review/ Code review etc can be planned.

CE2708:

We should aim to deliver the Purchase Order reuse Notes BO in our modernized API.

We should start with the productive implementation of the Purchase Order new persistency. The required CDS views, BDEFs etc have to be created.

The new PO Notes BO should be able to plug in to the RAP Reuse interface.

Check SDM Delivery: Is it possible to have SDM delivery and new persistency table delivery in the same release? If yes, SDM have to be planned

All other business objects have to plan for regression tests in order to make sure that none of the changes have affected the existing functionality. (The legacy PO applications also have to be tested in addition to this, - ME21N, Manage PO app, oDATA V4 API 2, Paas API etc.)

The Concept document presented in CE2702 will be used as the foundation and same can be used by other BOs to start with their analysis and POCs if needed.

CE2802:

Check with the other Business Objects and once all linked BOs have moved, SDM have to be planned.

Regression tests in all BOs and APIs to be planned once SDM is finished.

